



Final results of the poll conducted by **LINUX For You** on its Facebook page (<http://www.facebook.com/LinuxForYou>)

model ensures that Linux is marketed more outside the technical community as well."

Show me the money

The myth "It is difficult to make money from open source" ranked third in our survey. Since open source is 'free', many wonder where the money in open source comes from. The open source business model is different, and the money comes from services and support, not from the licence. Companies like Red Hat and Novell offer paid support plans and specialised Linux-based software to business users. Anuj Kumar, MD, Red Hat India, explains, "One can download open source software without paying for licences. However, support, management and upgrades are required to run the software. This is where commercial open source generates revenue. At Red Hat, our business model is referred to as the subscription model, and it is the most effective way to deploy, manage, and secure open source technology."

Moreover, the need for skilled manpower due to increased commercial Linux deployment also drives more Linux training and certification. "More employment opportunities ensure that the 'geeks' can make a living with Linux, rather than treating Linux as an indulgence for their spare time. The commercial benefits of the model also allow companies like SUSE to invest in research and development, opening more employment opportunities."

By: Jalaja Ramanunni

The author is a business correspondent at the EFY Group. She is a fan of anything portable, and loves exploring different genres of music and movies.

This model provides a win-win scenario for all involved, offering different benefits to customers, partners and vendors."

What's free about open source?

Jyothi Bacche, head, Open Source Practice, MindTree, feels that the most prevalent myth about open source is, "Free" in FOSS means 'free' as in 'cost'. "Free" in this context is a matter of the users' freedom to run, copy, distribute, study, change and improve the software. Bacche reveals that she has seen many users only treating open source software as freeware, not focusing on the rights it gives to users in terms of free access to source code.

In the Facebook survey, the least number of votes went to, "It is difficult for open source professionals to find a job." Advani reasons, "This is because people know that there is great scope in open source and FOSS professionals are more in demand, and that they usually get a higher salary."

The bottom line

The arguments for and against open source gradually get trivialised once people start exploring open source for themselves. Verna feels that Linux and open source have to be popularised among the mainstream audience. "We, as developers and users, have a responsibility to spread the word that Linux is for everybody," he concludes. **END**



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